Leader resource · all sixteen posted studies · NKJV

Galatians: Charts from the Sixteen Studies

Every chart from the sixteen Galatians studies, in study order — one section per study, with leader notes on every slide.

The series at a glance (1 of 2)

Studies 1–8

#	Passage	Title	In brief
1	1:1–5	**The Ground of Liberty**	Paul's God-given apostleship and the grace by which believers stand
2	1:6–10	**The One True Gospel**	Adding law to grace replaces the gospel; any other gospel stands accursed
3	1:11–17	**Paul's Independent Revelation**	Paul's gospel came by direct revelation of Jesus Christ, not from man
4	1:18–2:10	**Paul's Gospel Is Independent of the Judean Churches**	Confirmed by the Judean churches and recognized by the Jerusalem apostles
5	2:11–21	**Peter Goes Back to School**	Grace governs how believers live together; Paul corrects Peter publicly
6	3:1–5	**Under a Spell**	Five questions expose the folly of turning from grace to law
7	3:6–14	**Blessing or a Curse**	The law can only curse; Christ became a curse so the blessing comes by faith
8	3:15–29	**The Superiority of the Promise to the Law**	The law cannot annul the promise; it served to drive sinners to Christ

The series at a glance (2 of 2)

Studies 9–16

#	Passage	Title	In brief
9	4:1–11	**When I Became a Man**	From child-heir under guardians to son and heir — don't go back to slavery
10	4:12–20	**A Steel Fist in a Velvet Glove**	Paul the pastor pleads: become like me — until Christ is formed in you
11	4:21–31	**Paul's Old Testament Story**	Two sons, two covenants: cast out the bondwoman and stand in liberty
12	5:1–12	**Taking a Stand in Liberty**	Stand fast in liberty; adding to grace forfeits its profit
13	5:13–26	**Walk in the Spirit**	Liberty is not license; walk in the Spirit, who produces the fruit
14	6:1–5	**Brothers and Burdens**	Restore the fallen gently; each one carries his own load
15	6:6–10	**Sowing and Reaping**	God is not mocked: sow to the Spirit and don't grow weary
16	6:11–18	**Teaching the Truth**	Present the truth persuasively, precisely, plainly, positively, personally

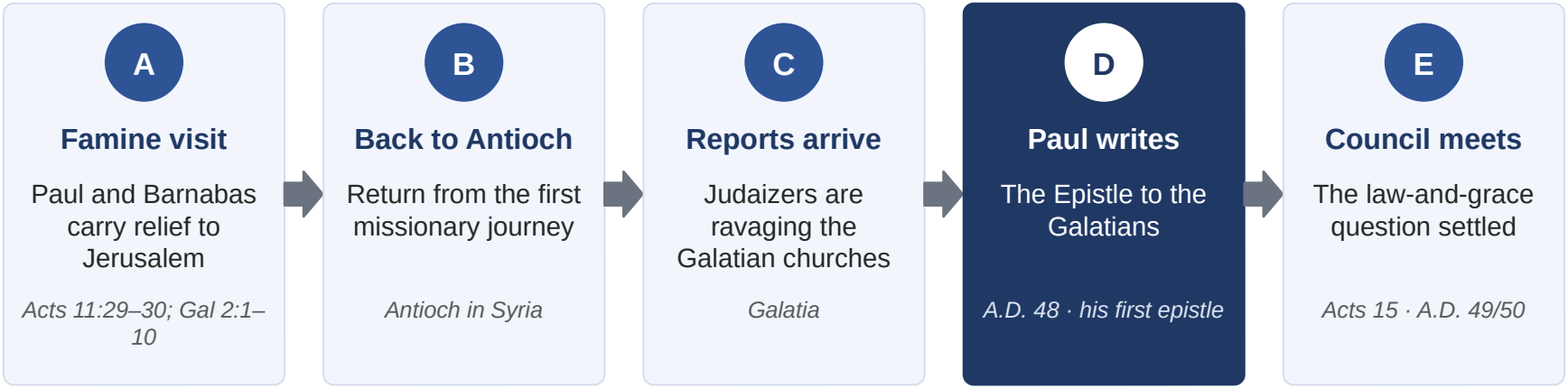
Study 1 of 16 · Galatians 1:1–5

The Ground of Liberty

Paul lays the ground of liberty: his God-given authority as an apostle, and the grace by which believers stand — the very things the Judaizers were undermining.

Where Galatians fits in Acts

Background III–IV · Date and place of writing



Recipients — South Galatia

- The churches of the first journey: Derbe, Lystra, Iconium, Antioch (in Pisidia)
- A group epistle — “to the churches” (1:2)

Written from Antioch in Syria

- Paul's home church and base for several years
- Before the council — so the council's letter is never cited

Why South Galatia?

Background II · The recipients

North Galatia		South Galatia ✓ commentary's view
• Upper region of Asia Minor • Paul did not go there until the second missionary journey • The letter could then be no earlier than about A.D. 53–54	vs	• The churches Paul planted on the first missionary journey • Derbe, Lystra, Iconium, Antioch in Pisidia • The letter comes before the council — A.D. 48

The main reason: no mention of the Jerusalem Council. The council settled this exact issue — Gentiles do not keep the Law for salvation or sanctification. Had it met already, Paul would simply have cited its letter.

Six characteristics of Galatians

Background V · What sets this letter apart

A Contrasts in feelings

Great love for the Galatian believers — and a godly hatred of the Judaizers' teaching

B A group epistle

Like Ephesians, written to a circle of churches, not one congregation

C No thanksgiving

The only Pauline letter with no thanksgiving in the salutation

D Autobiographical

With 2 Corinthians, the letter that tells us most about Paul's own life

E Parallel with Romans

Romans tells what justification by faith is; Galatians tells what it is not

F A unique ending

“Large letters” (6:11) — likely Paul's own large handwriting, due to his eyesight

The Judaizers: their message and their appeal

Background VI · Who Paul is answering

Their message

In the Gospels
Salvation is by the Law — circumcision is necessary for salvation.

In the Epistles
Sanctification is by the Law — keeping the Law is necessary to please God and live a holy life.

Their appeal

1. **The Scriptures on their side**
   Only the OT (plus James, perhaps Matthew) existed — “it says here you must be circumcised”
2. **Natural sympathy, Jew to Jew**
   “We're both Jews here — don't you believe the law?”
3. **Man's religiosity**
   People want something to do: rules, rituals, works
4. **The “mother church”**
   They came from Jerusalem; Paul came from Gentile Antioch

Reading rule from the commentary: remember where we are in Paul's argument, and let that guide how you read any single verse.

“Not from men nor through man”

Galatians 1:1 · Exposition 1 — The Writer

Paul, an apostle

ἀπόστολος apostolos · G652

- “One who is sent”
- Not in dispute: Paul was sent
- In dispute: sent by whom?
- Answering it is the letter's direct purpose

Not from / through men

No group of men

- Not the apostles in Jerusalem
- Not the leaders in Antioch

No single man

- Not Ananias in Damascus
- Not Barnabas, who brought him to Antioch

But through

- Jesus Christ
- and God the Father who raised Him from the dead
- Paul is a spokesman for God

When they couldn't argue with Paul's doctrine, they attacked his person. Verse 1 answers them before the letter begins.

The ground of liberty, verse by verse

Galatians 1:1–5 · Exposition outline points 1–6

v.1	1 · The Writer — “Paul, an apostle”	**ἀπόστολος** sent — but by God, not men
v.2	2 · The Readers — “to the churches of Galatia” (plural)	Derbe, Lystra, Iconium, Antioch
v.3a	3 · The Greeting — “Grace to you and peace”	**χάρις · εἰρήνη** Greek greeting · Jewish greeting
v.3b	4 · The Source — “from God the Father and our Lord Jesus Christ”	the Father is our Father too
v.4a	5 · The Basis — “who gave Himself for our sins”	**δούς · ἑαυτόν** voluntary · total
v.4b	6 · The Purpose — “that He might deliver us from this present evil age”	**ἐξέληται** rescue — now and when He returns
v.5	Doxology — “to whom be glory forever and ever. Amen”	**δόξα** the Father's glory (cf. Phil 2:11)

Grace and peace — a greeting with a point

Galatians 1:3 · Exposition 3 — The Greeting

Grace — the Greek greeting

χάρις charis · G5485 · Nom. Fem. Sg.

- Here, not grace for salvation
- God's unmerited favor sufficient to sustain the believer's daily life
- The very truth the Judaizers undermined by adding law-keeping

Peace — the Jewish greeting

εἰρήνη · שָׁלוֹם eirēnē · G1515 · LXX: shalom

- Positive wholeness and wellness
- Enjoyed when right with God, positionally and experientially
- Only a believer living under grace can extend it

Our goal: hold fast to grace so we may serve God acceptably. You cannot give a greeting of grace apart from living under it.

“Who gave Himself … that He might deliver us”

Galatians 1:4–5 · Exposition 5–6 — Basis and purpose

He gave δούς Aor. Act. Ptc.	Himself ἑαυτόν Acc. Masc. Sg. (reflexive)	Might deliver ἐξέληται Aor. Mid. Subj.
• Active voice • A voluntary death — not a tragedy that overtook Him • “No one takes My life from Me”	• Personal and total surrender • His whole person, not merely His body • Ground of complete forgiveness	• To pluck out, rescue • Future: when He returns • Present: from this evil age now (John 17:15–17)

Salvation is not just a ticket to heaven — but it is that. Verse 5: “to whom be glory forever and ever. Amen.”

Discuss and apply

Galatians 1:1–5 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. Why does Paul spend so much of verse 1 defending his apostleship before he even gets to his main subject?

2. How does Paul's use of “grace” in verse 3 differ from how the word is often used today?

Apply

Resting in a Settled Identity
Write down one identity truth Scripture gives you and read it aloud each morning this week.

Living Under Grace, Not Under Law
Name one “rule” you've kept to feel acceptable to God, and replace it with a specific act of grateful obedience.

In one line: Paul's authority came from God — and the grace that saves us is the grace that sustains us.

Study 2 of 16 · Galatians 1:6–10

The One True Gospel

Turning from grace is desertion from Christ Himself. Adding law to grace doesn't modify the gospel — it replaces it, and any other gospel stands under God's curse.

The passage at a glance

Galatians 1:6–10 · Outline from the posted Part 1 table

I. The Galatians' Desertion · vv.6–7

- A · Turning from grace is military desertion — voluntary and already underway
- B · Deserted from Christ, the One who called them
- C · Deserted to a perverted gospel — law added to grace replaces it

II. The Curse · vv.8–9

- A · Unlikely scenario: even Paul or an angel would be accursed
- B · Likely scenario: the Judaizers preaching a different gospel now
- Scripture alone is the test of truth

III. Paul's Wisdom · v.10

- Paul serves Christ, not human approval
- Grace, not works, is what glorifies Jesus

Deserting — and so soon

Galatians 1:6 · Outline I.A–B

“You are turning away”

μετατίθεσθε metatithesthe · Pres. Mid. Ind. 2nd Pl.

Military term — a soldier deserting his post in battle

Present tense — already underway

Middle voice — self-initiated, voluntary

“So soon” — within about a year of Paul's visit

From whom? To what?

From Him who called you

τοῦ καλέσαντος Aor. Act. Ptc. — the caller is Christ, not Paul

in the grace of Christ — **χάριτι** (dative): the sphere of the call

To a different gospel

A counterfeit with additions and requirements — no good news at all

It was never really about the messenger: to reject the grace gospel is to reject the One who called — Jesus Christ Himself.

“A different gospel, which is not another”

Galatians 1:6–7 · Outline I.C

Different in kind **ἕτερος** heteron · G2087	**Another of the same kind** **ἄλλος** allo · G243
• What the Judaizers preach (v.6) • A categorically different message	• What it is not (v.7) • No legitimate alternative gospel exists — only imitations

v.6–7	“gospel” — three times in two verses: which good news?	**εὐαγγέλιον** only one is entitled to the name
v.7	“some who trouble you” — confusion replacing settled confidence	**ταράσσοντες** Pres. Act. Ptc. — ongoing
v.7	“want to pervert the gospel of Christ”	**μεταστρέψαι** to turn to the opposite — invert it

Two scenarios, one verdict

Galatians 1:8–9 · Outline II.A–B

Unlikely — v.8

- “Even if we, or an angel from heaven”
- Even Paul himself is not exempt

Likely — v.9

- “If anyone preaches any other gospel”
- The Judaizers in Galatia, now

“Let him be accursed”

ἀνάθεμα anathema · G331

- Something devoted to destruction
- LXX: renders Hebrew חֵרֶם (cherem), the ban (Josh 6:17)
- Said twice — “as we have said before, so now I say again”
- The test is the message, measured by the Word — not the messenger

Pleasing men, or serving Christ?

Galatians 1:10 · Outline III — Paul's wisdom

v.10a	“Do I now persuade men, or God?” — the charge: a gospel shaped to win favor	**πείθω** persuade; seek to win favor
v.10b	“Or do I seek to please men?”	**ἀρέσκω** to please, accommodate
v.10c	“I would not be a bondservant of Christ”	**δοῦλος** one Master — not Christ and the crowd

Serving from fear

- Unsure enough has been done to be saved — or to stay saved
- Works become a way to keep the account settled

Serving from love

- Jesus has already paid the debt in full
- “The love of Christ compels us” (2 Cor 5:14)

Discuss and apply

Galatians 1:6–10 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. According to 1:6b, whose call were the Galatians actually rejecting when they abandoned Paul's gospel — and why does that matter?

2. Why does Paul pronounce the same curse (ἀνάθεμα) on an unlikely messenger and a likely one?

Apply

Grace Cannot Be Improved Upon

Write out in one sentence how a person receives eternal life. Check it against Ephesians 2:8–9 and John 3:16.

Test Every Message Against the Word

Pick one teaching you've accepted secondhand and trace it back to see whether it holds up against the Word.

In one line: There is one gospel — grace — and anything added to it is no gospel at all.

Study 3 of 16 · Galatians 1:11–17

Paul's Independent Revelation

The gospel Paul preached did not originate with man, was not handed to him by man, and was not taught in any human school. It came by direct revelation of Jesus Christ — and a transformed life only God could explain confirmed it.

Four proofs from Paul's own story

Galatians 1:11–17 · The commentary's outline

I	II	III	IV
Paul's Claim	**Paul's Conduct**	**Paul's Call**	**Paul's Course**
A divine revelation	Before conversion	To preach	After conversion
1:11–12	*1:13–14*	*1:15–16a*	*1:16b–17*

“Brethren” — 11 times in Galatians

- The believers, the people in the pew

“Accursed” — twice (vv.8–9)

- The Judaizers — never called brethren here

Where did Paul's gospel come from?

Galatians 1:11–12 · Outline I — Paul's claim

Not fabrication
"not according to man" · v.11

Not imitation
"I neither received it from man" · v.12a

Not assimilation
"nor was I taught it" · v.12b

But a revelation — v.12c
ἀποκάλυψις apokalypsis · Gen. Fem. Sg.

- A laying bare, an uncovering of what was hidden
- "through the revelation of Jesus Christ"
- Received, not achieved — straight from Jesus Himself

Any gospel from men has things attached to believing. Paul's gospel: believe, and you have eternal life — nothing added.

Paul before grace

Galatians 1:13–14 · Outline II — Paul's conduct before conversion

v.13	“my former conduct in Judaism” — a whole way of life set against grace	**ἀναστροφή** manner of life, not one act
v.13	“I persecuted the church of God beyond measure” (Acts 8:1–3)	**ἐδίωκον** Imperf. — kept pursuing
v.13	“and tried to destroy it” — to eradicate, not just hurt (Acts 26:9–11)	**ἐπόρθουν** Imperf. — a sustained campaign
v.14	“I advanced in Judaism beyond many of my contemporaries”	**προέκοπτον** a pioneer cutting a path ahead
v.14	“exceedingly zealous” — sincere, yet misdirected (Phil 3:6)	**ζηλωτής** an ardent devotee
v.14	“the traditions of my fathers” — 613 human commandments around the law	**παραδόσεων** handed down; cf. Matt 23:13

The anvil has ruined hundreds of hammers. Even Paul could not prevail against the church (Matt 16:18).

Brought forth, sent forth — for a purpose

Galatians 1:15–16a · Outline III — Paul's call to preach

God's preparation — v.15

Brought forth
ἀφορίσας Aor. Ptc.

- Set apart from his mother's womb for service
- Cf. Jer 1:5

Sent forth
χάριτος Gen. Fem. Sg.

- “called me through His grace”
- Not deserved — and neither is ours

God's purpose — v.16a

Reveal His Son
ἀποκαλύψαι Aor. Inf.

- “in me” — not only by my mouth
- “Son” stresses His deity (John 20:31)

Reach the Gentiles
ἔθνεσιν Dat. Pl. Neut.

- “that I might preach Him among the Gentiles”
- Israel's zealot sent to the nations

You don't have to like the people God sends you to. God loves them — give them the gospel, and they become your brother or sister.

Three years with the Lord

Galatians 1:16b–17 · Outline IV — Paul's course after conversion

What he did not do

- Did not confer with flesh and blood — no human being
- Did not go up to Jerusalem to the apostles

προσανεθέμην
Aor. Mid. — lay a matter before another; a deliberate choice

Damascus
Converted on the road (Acts 9)

→

Arabia
About three years — revelation from the risen Lord

→

Damascus
Ministered — then over the wall in a basket

The Twelve

- About three years with Jesus
- One speaking to twelve

Paul

- About three years in Arabia
- One-on-one with the risen Lord

Want to hear what God told Paul, in succinct form? Read Romans.

Discuss and apply

Galatians 1:11–17 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. How does Paul's former conduct — persecuting and trying to destroy the church — strengthen his testimony rather than weaken it?

2. Why did Paul deliberately avoid Jerusalem and the apostles after his conversion, going instead to Arabia?

Apply

Grace Reaches the Least Likely

Name someone you've decided is beyond reach and pray for them specifically, asking God to do for them what He did for Paul.

Called Before You Could Earn It

Thank God today for a purpose in your life that began before you could have earned it.

In one line: Paul's gospel came by revelation, not invention — and a changed life proved it.

Study 4 of 16 · Galatians 1:18 – 2:10

Paul's Gospel Is Independent of the Judean Churches

Paul's gospel and apostleship were never subordinate to Jerusalem — confirmed by the Judean churches' own testimony and the Jerusalem apostles' own recognition.

Paul's five visits to Jerusalem

Introduction · Acts and Galatians together

#	Visit	Acts	Galatians	What happened
1	**After leaving Damascus**	9:26–30	**1:18–20**	Barnabas brings him to the apostles; he preaches boldly
2	**The famine visit**	11:27–30	**2:1–10**	Relief from Antioch; Paul discusses his gospel privately
3	The Jerusalem Council	15	—	The law-and-grace question settled (A.D. 49/50)
4	End of the second journey	—	—	Greets the church, returns to Antioch
5	The final visit	—	—	Taken in the temple; two years in Caesarea, two in Rome

Galatians covers visits 1 and 2 only — it was written before visit 3, the council.

Why 2:1–10 is the famine visit, not the council

Galatians 1:20; 2:10 · The commentary's three reasons

1 **A solemn oath**
“Before God, I do not lie” (1:20). Paul is listing every visit; skipping one would be a lie.

ψεύδομαι
to speak falsely · Pres. Ind. 1st Sg.

2 **No council letter cited**
Acts 15 ended with a letter to the Gentile churches. Paul would surely have quoted it to settle the matter.

3 **Only “remember the poor”**
2:10 says nothing about things strangled or blood — requests in the council's letter.

πτωχῶν
the destitute · Gen. Pl.

Conclusion: Galatians 2:1–10 is the famine visit of Acts 11:27–30 — A.D. 48, before the council of A.D. 49/50.

Paul's early travels

Galatians 1:18–21 · Outline I.A–B

After three years	Barnabas vouches	Disputes with Hellenists	Sent away	Syria and Cilicia
Up to Jerusalem to see Peter; only James besides	The disciples were afraid; Barnabas brings him to the apostles	As Stephen had — and they seek to kill him	Down to Caesarea and off to Tarsus	Ministry in his home region
1:18–19	*Acts 9:26–28*	*Acts 9:29*	*Acts 9:30*	*1:21*

“to see Peter” — v.18
ἱστορῆσαι Aor. Act. Inf.

- To visit and become acquainted — not to be taught

“before God, I do not lie” — v.20
ψεύδομαι Pres. Ind. 1st Sg.

- A solemn oath: this account of his visits is complete

How the Judean churches responded

Galatians 1:22–24 · Outline I.C

They did not know him · v.22
ἀγνοούμενος Pres. Pass. Ptc.

"unknown by face to the churches of Judea" — a stranger by sight

They heard · v.23

"He who formerly persecuted us now preaches the faith which he once tried to destroy"

They glorified God · v.24
ἐδόξαζον Imperf. Act.

"they glorified God in me" — grace, not Paul's achievement

Acts 9:31 — walking in the fear of the Lord and the comfort of the Holy Spirit, the church multiplied.

The famine visit: who went, and why

Galatians 2:1–2 · Outline II.A–B

The representatives — vv.1–2a

Time 14 years after Paul's conversion

Team Paul (leader), Barnabas, and Titus — a Gentile, uncircumcised; his first mention

Text The gospel Paul preached — the gospel of grace

The reason — v.2

By revelation Agabus foretold the famine (Acts 11:27–30); not summoned

Privately not a council or public meeting

And communicated **ἀνεθέμην** — laid it before them to be on the same page, not to ask if it was true

“Lest I might run, or had run, in vain” — if Jerusalem demanded law-keeping of Gentiles, Paul would be running uphill.

The disruption: liberty under attack

Galatians 2:3–5 · Outline II.C.1–2

Slipped in	**ψευδαδέλφους** false brothers — by stealth, under false pretenses (v.4a)
Spied out	**κατασκοπῆσαι** “our liberty which we have in Christ Jesus” (v.4b)
To enslave	**καταδουλώσουσιν** bring us back into the bondage of the law (v.4c)
Targeted Titus	a Greek, uncircumcised — compel him and set a precedent (v.3)

Paul's response — v.5

- “We did not yield submission even for an hour”
- “that the truth of the gospel might continue with you”

ἐλευθερίαν liberty — every believer's from the moment of faith

Add one thing to the gospel and you have made it a false gospel. Separate what you should do from what you have to do: believe.

What the apostles did — and did not do

Galatians 2:6–10 · Outline II.C.3 — Reaction of the apostles

a · v.6	Added nothing to Paul's gospel — God shows personal favoritism to no man	**πρόσωπον λαμβάνει** “receives the face” — judges by status
b · v.7	Saw his gospel was the same as Peter's — to Gentile and Jew alike	**πεπίστευμαι** Perf. Pass. — entrusted, and still so
c · v.8	Recognized the same power at work in Peter and in Paul	God gives the increase (1 Cor 3:6)
d · v.9	James, Peter and John gave the right hand of fellowship	**κοινωνίας** full partnership, one gospel
e · v.10	Asked only that they remember the poor — what Paul came to do	**πτωχῶν** a fruit of grace, not an addition

Discuss and apply

Galatians 1:18 – 2:10 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. Paul went to Jerusalem “by revelation” and discussed his gospel almost as an aside. What does that order of events protect?

2. What two-fold purpose did the false brothers have in 2:4, and how does καταδουλόω (“to enslave”) describe the stakes?

Apply

Not Yielding, Not Even for an Hour
Practice stating the gospel this week in one sentence, with nothing added to “believe.”

Bring the Relief, Discuss the Gospel Along the Way
Meet one practical need for someone in your church family this week, without waiting for a “spiritual” reason.

In one line: Jerusalem added nothing to Paul's gospel. There is one gospel — and the ground is level at the cross.

Study 5 of 16 · Galatians 2:11–21

Peter Goes Back to School

The gospel of grace governs not only how a person is saved but how believers live together — and even a Spirit-taught apostle can drift under social pressure, needing loving but public correction anchored in justification by faith alone.

Four marks of the confrontation

Galatians 2:11–14 · Outline I — Paul confronts Peter about the gospel

A **Public · v.11**

ἀντέστην
“I withstood him to his face” — and “before them all” (v.14)

B **Pointed · v.12**

ὑπέστελλεν
Ate with Gentiles — then withdrew when men came from James

C **Poisonous · v.13**

συνυπεκρίθησαν
The rest of the Jews joined in — “even Barnabas was carried away”

D **Practical · v.14**

ὀρθοποδοῦσιν
Not “straight-footed” about the truth of the gospel

“If you, being a Jew, live in the manner of Gentiles and not as the Jews, why do you compel Gentiles to live as Jews?” (v.14)

Peter knew better

Galatians 2:11 · Outline I.A.1–3

1 **Prepared better — Acts 10**
The sheet from heaven: “What God has cleansed you must not call common.” He then went to Cornelius.

about A.D. 40
taught by revelation

2 **Preached better — Acts 11:17**
“Who was I that I could withstand God?” — he defended eating with Gentiles before the Jerusalem leaders.

3 **Promised better — Galatians 2:9**
James, Peter and John gave Paul the right hand of fellowship: you go to the Gentiles.

“He was to be blamed” — κατεγνωσμένος, Perf. Pass. Ptc.: his conduct stood condemned, not his standing before God.

How the drift happened

Galatians 2:12–13 · Outline I.B–C

At Antioch	Men from James	He withdraws	The rest follow	Even Barnabas
Peter eats with the Gentile believers	Visitors arrive from the Jerusalem church	**ὑπέστελλεν** Imperfect — a gradual, repeated retreat	The other Jewish believers join him	“carried away with their hypocrisy”
v.12a	*v.12b*	*v.12c*	*v.13a*	*v.13b*

The example said there were two bodies of Christ — one Jewish, one Gentile. Hypocrisy spreads in community.

Separate by birth — the same by faith

Galatians 2:15–16 · Outline II — Paul corrects Peter

Separate — v.15
φύσει by nature, by birth

- “We who are Jews by nature, and not sinners of the Gentiles”
- Born Jews, not proselytes (Phil 3:4–5)
- A distinction Paul grants only to dissolve it

The same — v.16
δικαιόω to declare righteous · forensic

× **not by the works of the law**
three times in one verse

✓ **by faith in Jesus Christ**
three times in one verse

Any man, Jew or Gentile — a legal declaration received by faith

Six times in one verse: not by the law — but by faith. Justification is declared, not earned.

Paul's argument with Peter

Galatians 2:17–21 · Outline III

vv.17–18	Peter's error — rebuilding what he destroyed makes him the transgressor	**παραβάτης** one who oversteps a line
v.19	“Through the law I died to the law that I might live to God”	**ζήσω** dying to the law opens a new life
v.20a	Dead — “I have been crucified with Christ”	**συνεσταύρωμαι** Perf. — done, with lasting effect
v.20b	Alive — “Christ lives in me … I live by faith in the Son of God”	sanctification is by faith, too
v.21	“If righteousness comes through the law, then Christ died in vain”	**ἀθετῶ** “I do not set aside” — nullify

Discuss and apply

Galatians 2:11–21 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. Peter already knew the truth. What made him withdraw from the Gentiles anyway?

2. Why did Paul confront Peter publicly, “before them all,” rather than privately?

Apply

When Doing Right Costs You Socially
Name one place you've been managing others' opinions instead of living what you know is true — and take one visible step back toward it.

Resting in a Righteousness That Isn't Yours
Write down one way you've treated God's acceptance as conditional, then thank Him for the standing already yours in Christ.

In one line: Grace governs how we live together, not only how we are saved — knowing the truth must be matched by walking it.

Study 6 of 16 · Galatians 3:1–5

Under a Spell

Grace, not law, both received the Galatians into Christ and sustains them in Christ — so Paul's five questions expose the folly of turning from grace to law at every stage of the Christian life.

Five questions for foolish Galatians

Galatians 3:1–5 · The commentary's outline

v.1	Precedence — Christ crucified was placarded before them by grace first	**προεγράφη** posted up publicly
v.2	Procedure — they received the Spirit by the hearing of faith	**ἀκοῆς πίστεως** faith from what is heard
v.3	Perfection — begun by the Spirit, not finished by the flesh	**ἐπιτελεῖσθε** being made complete
v.4	Persecution — returning to law would empty their suffering of meaning	**εἰκῇ** in vain, to no purpose
v.5	Promotion — the Spirit's supply and miracles came by faith	**ἐπιχορηγῶν** lavish, ongoing supply

Foolish, bewitched — and Christ placarded

Galatians 3:1 · Outline I — The precedence of Christianity

1 **“O foolish Galatians”**

ἀνόητοι
Not demented — simply not using the sense God gave them

2 **“Who has bewitched you?”**

ἐβάσκανεν
Hyperbole: who put a hex on you? Their turn made no sense

3 **“Clearly portrayed”**

προεγράφη
Posted publicly, like a placard — in preaching, baptism and the Table

4 **“As crucified”**

ἐσταυρωμένος
Perfect participle — Christ stands permanently as the crucified One

How did you receive the Spirit?

Galatians 3:2 · Outline II — The procedure of Christianity

	By the works of the law?	By the hearing of faith ✓
What it is	Deeds done in obedience to the Mosaic code	Believing the message that was heard
Greek	ἔργων νόμου	ἀκοῆς πίστεως — faith arising from what is heard
The result	No — the Spirit never came this way	Yes — salvation and the Spirit at the same moment

Salvation and the reception of the Spirit are simultaneous, though not synonymous. Some 33 things happen the moment a person believes (Chafer).

Begun in the Spirit — finished in the flesh?

Galatians 3:3 · Outline III — The perfection of Christianity

Having begun
πνεύματι by the Spirit

- The Christian life starts with the Spirit, received by faith

Now made perfect?
ἐπιτελεῖσθε Pres. Mid./Pass.

- An attempted, ongoing “finishing” project

By the flesh?
σαρκί self-effort

- Human effort in place of grace

“By one offering He has perfected forever those who are being sanctified” (Hebrews 10:14).

Suffering and supply

Galatians 3:4–5 · Outline IV–V — Persecution and promotion

Persecution — v.4
ἐπάθετε · εἰκῇ suffered · in vain

- They suffered for the gospel from the start
- “We must through many tribulations enter the kingdom” (Acts 14:22)
- Going back to law would make it all for nothing

Promotion — v.5
ἐπιχορηγῶν Pres. Act. Ptc.

- God keeps supplying the Spirit — lavishly
- Miracles among them, e.g. the lame man at Lystra (Acts 14:8–10)
- By the hearing of faith, not works of the law

Ongoing power comes the same way salvation did — by faith.

Discuss and apply

Galatians 3:1–5 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. What does it mean that receiving the Spirit and being saved are simultaneous but not synonymous?

2. Explain in your own words the difference between your perfection and your practice (3:3).

Apply

Trade Trying for Trusting
Tell God out loud today that you are trusting Him rather than trying to earn the outcome yourself.

Let Your Practice Catch Up to Your Perfection
Practice one habit this week as a response to being accepted — not as an attempt to become accepted.

In one line: What began by grace through faith continues by grace through faith.

Study 7 of 16 · Galatians 3:6–14

Blessing or a Curse

The law can save no one — it can only curse those who fail to keep it perfectly. God has always justified sinners as He justified Abraham: by faith alone. Christ became a curse in our place so the blessing of Abraham and the promised Spirit come by faith.

Faith, its substitute, and its solution

Galatians 3:6–14 · The commentary's outline

I. The Study of Faith · vv.6–9

- Foundation — Abraham believed God (v.6)
- Fellowship — only those of faith are Abraham's sons (v.7)
- Fruit — the nations blessed by faith (vv.8–9)

II. The Substitute for Faith · vv.10–12

- Fabrication — a curse is tied to the law (v.10a)
- Obstruction — the law itself says the just live by faith (vv.11–12)
- Compensation — everyone is under the curse (v.10b)

III. The Solution of Faith · vv.13–14

- Christ became a curse for us (v.13)
- Christ bestowed the blessing — and the promised Spirit (v.14)

Abraham: the pattern for justification

Galatians 3:6–9 · Outline I — The study of faith

A Foundation · v.6

ἐπίστευσεν · ἐλογίσθη

Abraham believed; righteousness was credited to his account — not earned

B Fellowship · v.7

υἱοί

Only those of faith are sons of Abraham — whatever the family tree says

C Fruit · vv.8–9

προευηγγελίσατο

The gospel preached to Abraham beforehand: “In you all the nations shall be blessed” (Gen 12:3)

Then and now, God justifies the same way: by faith alone, apart from works.

Why the law can only curse

Galatians 3:10–12 · Outline II — The substitute for faith

A curse is attached	Keep all of it?	No one does	The law's own witness
κατάραν “Cursed is everyone who does not continue in all things” (Deut 27:26)	“The man who does them shall live by them” (Lev 18:5)	The weakness was in the people, not the law (Heb 8:7–8)	“The just shall live by faith” (Hab 2:4)
v.10	*v.12*	*v.10*	*v.11*

Everyone who does not keep the whole law is cursed — and no one has kept it. We are all under the curse.

“The just shall live by faith” — three times

Habakkuk 2:4 in the New Testament · Outline II.B

Romans 1:17

- Tells who the just are

Galatians 3:11

- Tells how the just shall live
- δίκαιος · ζήσεται — the believer's ongoing life of faith

Hebrews 10:38

- Explains what “by faith” means — introducing Hebrews 11

Even under the law, the law itself testified that righteousness comes by faith.

Christ became a curse for us

Galatians 3:13–14 · Outline III — The solution of faith

v.13a	“Christ has redeemed us from the curse of the law”	**ἐξηγόρασεν** bought out of the slave market
v.13b	“having become a curse for us”	**γενόμενος** He became the curse in our place
vv.10, 13	Deut 27:26 and Deut 21:23 — the same word binds them	**ἐπικατάρατος** “cursed” — law's curse, Christ's curse
v.14a	“that the blessing of Abraham might come upon the Gentiles”	justification by faith, apart from law
v.14b	“that we might receive the promise of the Spirit through faith”	**ἐπαγγελίαν** received by faith, not works

Discuss and apply

Galatians 3:6–14 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. What does it mean that righteousness was “accounted” to Abraham (v.6)? How does that differ from earning it?

2. In what sense did Christ “become a curse” for us (v.13), and what does “redeemed” (ἐξαγοράζω) add?

Apply

Resting in an Imputed Righteousness
Write down one place you're tempted to “earn” what God has given freely, and replace the striving with a prayer of thanks.

Refusing to Trade Good News for Bad News
When you share your faith this week, consciously keep the gospel free of add-on requirements.

In one line: The law can only curse; Christ took the curse so the blessing comes by faith.

Study 8 of 16 · Galatians 3:15–29

The Superiority of the Promise to the Law

The law, arriving 430 years later, cannot annul or add to God's unconditional promise to Abraham. It was temporary, needed a mediator, and served to drive sinners to Christ — while the promise makes believers sons and heirs forever.

The promise and the law: four comparisons

Galatians 3:15–29 · The commentary's outline

I Not part of the promise

3:15–18 — a confirmed covenant can't be annulled or added to

II Not on a par with it

3:19–20 — added for transgressions, temporary, needed a mediator

III A purpose in the promise

3:21–25 — exposed weakness and sin, and drove us to Christ

IV Inferior prospects

3:26–29 — sons, clothed with Christ, one in Christ, heirs

The law was holy and good — it did its job, and now it is gone. Salvation is by grace through faith, plus not one thing.

A covenant only God could keep

Galatians 3:15–16 · Genesis 12 and 15 · Outline I.A–B

God told him	Abraham asked	Abraham slept	God alone passed
“I will bless you…” — no requirements placed on Abraham	“How shall I know?” — animals laid out as for a covenant	A deep sleep fell on him — he could not be a party	A smoking furnace and a burning lamp passed between the pieces
Gen 12:3	*Gen 15:8–10*	*Gen 15:12*	*Gen 15:17*

A covenant — v.15
διαθήκη a will; once confirmed, unalterable

- No one annuls or adds to it but its makers

The Seed — v.16
σπέρμα singular

- “and to your Seed,” who is Christ

Three unconditional promises to Abraham

Galatians 3:16–18 · Outline I.B–C

1	**Land** Expanded in the Palestinian Covenant	**Deut 29–30**
2	**Nation** Expanded in the Davidic Covenant	**2 Samuel 7**
3	**Blessing** Ultimately the New Covenant	**Jer 31 · Heb 8**

The law came too late — v.17
430 years

- Cannot annul a covenant “confirmed before by God”

The law contradicts the promise — v.18

- If the inheritance is of the law, it is no longer of promise
- Promise and law cannot be mixed

Law and promise side by side

Galatians 3:17–20 · Outline II — Not on a par with the promise

	The Law	The Promise
Arrived	430 years after the promise	First — confirmed beforehand by God
Came because of	Transgressions — disobedience (παράβασις)	Obedience — Abraham believed God
Duration	Temporary — “till the Seed should come”	Permanent
Parties	Two — needed a mediator, Moses (μεσίτης)	One — “God is one”; no mediator
Terms	Conditional: do this and live	Unconditional: God alone bound Himself

What the law was for

Galatians 3:21–25 · Outline III — The law had a purpose

A Demonstrate weakness

μὴ γένοιτο
v.21 — no law could give life; “Certainly not!”

B Display sinfulness

συνέκλεισεν
v.22 — Scripture shut up all under sin (Rom 3:9, 23)

C Drive to Christ

παιδαγωγός
vv.23–25 — the slave-escort until faith came; now no longer under him

You can't be saved until you know you need to be saved. The law showed the need; Christ meets it.

What the promise gives that the law never could

Galatians 3:26–29 · Outline IV — Higher, deeper, wider, longer

↑ Higher · v.26

υἱοί θεοῦ
Sons of God through faith in Christ Jesus

↓ Deeper · v.27

ἐνεδύσασθε
Baptized by the Spirit into Christ — clothed with Him (1 Cor 12:13)

↔ Wider · v.28

Neither Jew nor Greek, slave nor free, male nor female — all one in Christ

∞ Longer · v.29

κληρονόμοι
Abraham's seed and heirs according to the promise — forever

Discuss and apply

Galatians 3:15–29 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. What does it mean that Abraham was asleep while God alone passed through the pieces (Genesis 15)?

2. Of the four ways our standing surpasses the law — higher, deeper, wider, longer — which means most to you right now, and why?

Apply

Rest in “You Have Been Blessed, Do This”
Before you pray tonight, say aloud “I have already been blessed” before anything you plan to do for God.

Live the Wide Ground
Extend a specific honor this week to a believer you might ordinarily overlook.

In one line: The promise came first and stands forever; the law's work was to lead us to Christ.

Study 9 of 16 · Galatians 4:1–11

When I Became a Man

Before Christ, even the heir lived no differently than a slave. In the fullness of time God sent His Son to redeem those under law and make them sons and heirs — so turning back to rule-keeping only trades one slavery for another.

The child-heir under guardians

Galatians 4:1–3 · Outline I — Our situation

v.1	The heir, while a child, “does not differ at all from a slave”	**νήπιος · δοῦλος** a minor · a slave
v.1	“though he is master of all” — legally owns the estate	**κληρονόμος** heir
v.2	“under guardians and stewards” — over his person and his estate	**ἐπιτρόπους · οἰκονόμους** guardian · household manager
v.2	“until the time appointed by the father” — the date set in the will	**προθεσμίας** appointed time
v.3	“Even so we … were in bondage under the elements of the world”	**στοιχεῖα** rudiments — Jew and Gentile alike

“When the fullness of the time had come”

Galatians 4:4 · Outline II.A.1 — It was the right season

a A common language

Greek, spread by Alexander — precise enough for theology

b Roads and travel

Roman roads let evangelists move town to town

c Pax Romana

Roman peace; citizens protected across the empire

d Bankrupt paganism

Pagan religions offered nothing of eternal value

e The failure of Israel

Failed leadership and a failed mission to the nations

✓ The right Savior

γενόμενον ἐκ γυναικός
born of a woman, born under the law

Four A's of our salvation

Galatians 4:4–7 · Outline II — Our salvation

Arrival	Adoption	Advent of the Spirit	Abolition of slavery
ἐξαγοράσῃ God sent His Son to redeem those under the law	**υἱοθεσίαν** Placed as sons — about the inheritance, not entry	**κρᾶζον** “Abba, Father!” — an ongoing cry	**οὐκέτι δοῦλος** No longer a slave but a son — and an heir
vv.4–5a	*v.5b*	*v.6*	*v.7*

We are born into the family; adoption is about the inheritance — received the moment we believed.

Back to the beggarly elements?

Galatians 4:8–11 · Outline III — Our selection

Ignorant	Illumined	Immersed in the law	About to be dis-inherited
Served those which by nature are not gods	Came to know God — rather, were known by God	Days, months, seasons, years — weak and beggarly	“Lest I have labored for you in vain”
v.8	*v.9a*	*vv.9b–10*	*v.11*

What Paul fears — and what he does not

- Not lost salvation: eternal life, received by grace through faith, is forever
- But trading pagan slavery for law slavery — no better off than before

Discuss and apply

Galatians 4:1–11 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. What is the difference between how we enter God's family (birth) and how we receive the inheritance (adoption)?

2. In verses 9–11, why is Paul “afraid” for the Galatians, if he is not questioning their salvation?

Apply

Let “Abba” Change How You Pray
Begin at least one prayer time this week simply saying, “Abba, Father.”

Don't Trade Grace for Another Slavery
Name one rule-keeping substitute for grace in your life and bring it to a trusted friend or your group.

In one line: You are no longer a slave but a son and an heir — don't go back to the beggarly elements.

Study 10 of 16 · Galatians 4:12–20

A Steel Fist in a Velvet Glove

After three chapters of rebuke, Paul pleads as a father: he shows his affection for the Galatians and his authentic loyalty to them, laboring again until Christ is formed in them.

Paul's affection and allegiance

Galatians 4:12–20 · The commentary's outline

I. Paul's Affection · 4:12–16

A — His plea
Become like me — free from the Law (12a)

B — His problem
He first came in physical weakness (12b–13)

C — Their approval
They received him as an angel of God (14–15)

D — His persuasion
Am I your enemy for telling the truth? (16)

II. Paul's Allegiance · 4:17–20

A — Artificial loyalty
The Judaizers court you for no good (17)

B1 — Certainty
Zeal in a good thing, always (18)

B2 — Compassion
“My little children” (19a)

B3–4 — Check · character
Until Christ is formed in you; I wish I were there (19b–20)

Then and now

Galatians 4:13–16 · Outline I.B–D

	Then — when Paul first came	Now — after the Judaizers
Paul's condition	A physical infirmity (ἀσθένεια) — v.13	The same Paul, telling the same truth
Their response	Did not despise or spit him out — v.14	“Have I become your enemy?” (ἐχθρός) — v.16
How they saw him	“As an angel of God, even as Christ Jesus”	As an opponent
Their blessing	Would have plucked out their own eyes for him — v.15	“What then was the blessing you enjoyed?”

I told you the truth. Now I am your enemy. Conclusion: I became your enemy because I told you the truth.

Two kinds of zeal

Galatians 4:17–18 · Outline II.A–B.1

	The Judaizers — artificial	Paul — authentic
The verb	ζηλοῦσιν — they zealously court you	ζηλοῦσθαι — zealous in a good thing
The aim	“for no good”	the truth and your good
The method	ἐκκλεῖσαι — shut you out from Paul	present or absent, the same
The result	“that you may be zealous for them”	that Christ be formed in you

Zeal is not the test. The truth, and the good of others, is.

“Until Christ is formed in you”

Galatians 4:19–20 · Outline II.B.2–4

1 Compassion · v.19a

τεκνία
“My little children” — a term of endearment

2 Cost · v.19b

ὠδίνω
“I labor in birth again” — a second labor for the same children

3 Goal · v.19c

μορφωθῇ
Christ formed in you — inward, essential form (cf. Rom 12:2)

4 Character · v.20

ἀποροῦμαι
“I have doubts about you” — perplexed, wishing to be present

Dare to discipline — and then hold them close. Truth with a steel fist, in a velvet glove.

Discuss and apply

Galatians 4:12–20 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. How can Paul call his truth-telling the reason he became their “enemy” (v.16), and what does that warn us about?

2. What does it mean for Christ to be “formed” (μορφόω) in the Galatians, and how does that differ from simply believing correct doctrine?

Apply

Correct Like a Father, Labor Like a Mother
When you must say a hard true thing, pair it with a concrete word or act that shows the relationship survives it.

Aim at Formation, Not Attendance
Where you've managed behavior from the outside in, ask the Lord this week to do the inside-out work.

In one line: Speak the truth firmly, love tenderly, and labor until Christ is formed in others.

Study 11 of 16 · Galatians 4:21–31

Paul's Old Testament Story

Because Isaac, the child of promise, could never share an inheritance with Ishmael, the child of the flesh, the believer — born by the same kind of promise — must cast out every attempt to mix law-keeping with grace and stand in the freedom to which Christ has called him.

The key is the number two

Galatians 4:21–31 · Introduction

	Bondage — the left column	Freedom — the right column
Two sons	Ishmael	Isaac
Two women	Hagar, the bondwoman (παιδίσκη)	Sarah, the freewoman (ἐλευθέρα)
Two spheres	Flesh	Spirit — promise
Two covenants	Law	Promise
Two places	Arabia	Jerusalem
Two mountains	Sinai	Zion
Two Jerusalems	The Jerusalem that now is	The Jerusalem above (ἄνω)

Signed up without reading the fine print

Galatians 4:21 · Outline I — The argument

What they wanted	What they had not heard
• “You who desire to be under the law” • Law-keeping as their way to please God	• “Do you not hear the law?” • What the law demands — and what it produces • Paul's answer comes from the law itself: Genesis

They signed up for the law without reading what was in it.

Two sons, two births

Galatians 4:22–23 · Outline II.A–B

Ishmael — “according to the flesh”	Isaac — “through promise” δι' ἐπαγγελίας through promise
• Son of Hagar, the bondwoman	• Son of Sarah, the freewoman
• Sarah's plan, by human means	• When God said, as God said
• Apart from God's revealed will	• Against all natural possibility
• No miracle	• Abraham called at 75; God waited 25 years

Make it as hard as it can be — so that when it happens, everyone knows God did it.

History made into an allegory

Galatians 4:24–27 · Outline II.C — Two symbols

v.24a	Historical events, used as an allegory — not fiction	**ἀλληγορούμενα** Pres. Pass. Ptc. — made into
v.24b	Mount Sinai “gives birth to bondage” — Hagar	**γεννῶσα · δουλείαν** continually bearing · slavery
v.25	Hagar “corresponds to Jerusalem which now is”	**συστοιχεῖ** stands in the same rank
v.26	“The Jerusalem above is free, which is the mother of us all”	**ἄνω** above — heavenly
v.27	“Rejoice, O barren” — Isaiah 54:1	**στεῖρα** barren — yet more fruitful

Children of promise: four applications

Galatians 4:28–31 · Outline III — The application

A Children of promise

v.28
“Now we, brethren, as Isaac was, are children of promise”

B Candidates for persecution

ἐδίωκεν · v.29
The child of the flesh kept persecuting the child of the Spirit

C No compromise

Ἔκβαλε · v.30
“Cast out the bondwoman and her son” — they shall not be heirs together

D Called to liberty

v.31
“We are not children of the bondwoman but of the free”

Law: work six days, then rest — working for the blessing. Grace: rest first, then work — working from the blessing.

Discuss and apply

Galatians 4:21–31 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. Paul says the Jerusalem above “is the mother of us all.” What does it mean practically to live as a citizen of that city?

2. What would it look like concretely to “cast out” a legalistic rule you've let sit alongside your faith in Christ?

Apply

Know Which Column You're In
Identify one requirement you've added, and set it back outside your standing with God — not a condition of it.

Work From the Blessing, Not For It
Do one act of service this week from rest and gratitude rather than obligation to earn favor.

In one line: Two sons, two covenants — and only one column a believer can stand in.

Study 12 of 16 · Galatians 5:1–12

Taking a Stand in Liberty

Christ has set believers permanently and completely free from the Law; to add anything to that finished grace forfeits its profit, courts renewed bondage, and demeans the cross that purchased the freedom.

Stand fast — and don't be entangled again

Galatians 5:1 · Outline I — The request

The positive command — 5:1a
στήκετε Pres. Act. Impv. — keep standing

- “Stand fast therefore in the liberty by which Christ has made us free”
- Freedom already given (ἐλευθερία)
- Standing in it is a continuing choice

The negative command — 5:1b
ζυγῷ δουλείας yoke of bondage

- “Do not be entangled again”
- Gentiles: the yoke of pagan religion
- Jews: law-keeping to be accepted — now offered again

Freedom is a settled fact. Standing in it is an ongoing decision — it isn't automatic.

Three results of submitting to the law

Galatians 5:2–4 · Outline II — The results

A — **Denied the power of Christ — v.2**
"If you become circumcised, Christ will profit you nothing"

περιτέμνησθε
subjunctive — not yet final

B — **Indebted to keep the whole law — v.3**
All or nothing — no picking and choosing (cf. James 2:10)

ὀφειλέτης
a debtor

C — **Detached from the grace of God — v.4**
Estranged in fellowship, off course from grace — not loss of salvation

ἐξεπέσατε
a ship driven off course

"Fallen from grace" — their relationship with God was not affected; their walk was.

The Spirit-filled alternative

Galatians 5:5–6 · Outline III — The reality of the Spirit-filled life

We patiently hope — v.5
ἀπεκδεχόμεθα eagerly, fully wait

- “Through the Spirit” — not the law's fast way
- Forward-leaning, patient expectancy
- “the hope of righteousness by faith”

We passionately love — v.6
ἐνεργουμένη δι' ἀγάπης working through love

- Neither circumcision nor uncircumcision avails anything
- Faith operates through love
- Serving Christ from love, not fear

Love, not fear, is the motive for serving Christ.

Five marks of the teachers of the law

Galatians 5:7–12 · Outline IV — Their reputation

v.7	They challenge the truth — “Who hindered you from obeying the truth?”	**ἐνέκοψεν** cut in on your lane
v.8	They are contrary to God — “This persuasion does not come from Him”	**πεισμονή** used only here in the NT
v.9	They contaminate the church — “A little leaven leavens the whole lump”	**ζύμη** small, but pervasive
v.10	Their conviction is certain — “he who troubles you shall bear his judgment”	judgment belongs to God
vv.11–12	They condemn teachers of the truth — the offense of the cross	**ἀποκόψονται** “cut themselves off”

Works that follow — and works that don't

Galatians 5:1–12 · Conclusion

	Works added to grace	The work of the Lord
Motive	To be accepted or kept by God	Love for Christ, who already paid
Reach	Limited to this life — no door out	Follows the believer beyond this life
Outcome	Christ profits you nothing (v.2)	Rewarded at the judgment seat of Christ

Add anything to salvation, and you demean the cross that purchased the freedom.

Discuss and apply

Galatians 5:1–12 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. The Galatians were told “just one small thing” needed adding to their faith. What “small things” do people quietly add to grace today?

2. How would you describe the difference between serving Christ out of love and serving out of fear or guilt (5:6)?

Apply

Resist the “Just One Small Thing”
Name one addition before God as unnecessary — not wrong to do, but adding nothing to what Christ finished.

Take Your Stand
Where you've been passively hoping to feel free, make one concrete, deliberate decision instead.

In one line: Christ has made us free — stand there, and add nothing to grace.

Study 13 of 16 · Galatians 5:13–26

Walk in the Spirit

Christian liberty is not freedom to indulge the flesh but freedom to walk continually in step with the Holy Spirit — who alone produces, as fruit rather than forced works, what the law could only demand.

Three things to do with liberty

Galatians 5:13–15 · Outline I — The potential of liberty

A — Exploit it through license

ἀφορμή · v.13a
Don't turn liberty into a staging ground for the flesh

B — Explore it through love

δουλεύετε · v.13b–14
Through love serve one another — the law fulfilled in one word (πεπλήρωται)

C — Enjoy it through harmony

v.15
Don't bite and devour one another — written to believers

Positionally we are already free (5:1). Experientially we choose, day by day, to live up to that position.

Walk, conflict, led

Galatians 5:16–18 · Outline II — The performance of liberty

The command	The conflict	The call
περιπατεῖτε “Walk in the Spirit, and you shall not fulfill the lust of the flesh”	Flesh and Spirit are contrary — a war within the believer	“If you are led by the Spirit, you are not under the law”
v.16	*v.17*	*v.18*

Walking in the Spirit, not self-effort, is how the believer overcomes the flesh.

Works of the flesh, fruit of the Spirit

Galatians 5:19–23 · Outline III — The pictures of liberty

Works of the flesh — plural, self-produced
ἔργα τῆς σαρκός v.19

Sexual adultery, fornication, uncleanness, lewdness

Spiritual idolatry, sorcery

Social hatred, contentions, jealousies, outbursts of wrath, selfish ambitions, dissensions, heresies, envy, murders … “and the like”

Fruit of the Spirit — singular, grown
καρπός v.22

Upward love, joy, peace

Outward longsuffering, kindness, goodness

Inward faithfulness, gentleness, self-control

Love (ἀγάπη) comes first — self-sacrificing, the root of the rest

“Will not inherit the kingdom of God”

Galatians 5:21 · Outline III.A.2 — The danger of the works of the flesh

Not entering the kingdom

- Paul is writing to brethren — believers
- They have eternal life
- Entrance is promised and cannot be lost

But ruling with Christ in it

- Inheritance = reigning with Christ (Matt 19:29; Rev 2:26)
- Believers who live like unbelievers forfeit it
- Like Jacob's three sons in Genesis 49

When believers live like unbelievers, they will not rule with Christ in His righteous kingdom.

Participating in liberty

Galatians 5:24–26 · Outline IV

v.24	Provision — “those who are Christ's have crucified the flesh”	**ἐσταύρωσαν** aorist — a completed identification
v.16	Daily walking — ordinary, everyday conduct	**περιπατεῖτε** to walk around, conduct life
v.25	Power — “since we live in the Spirit, let us also walk in the Spirit”	**στοιχῶμεν** march in rank, keep step
v.26	Particulars — not conceited, not provoking, not envying	**κενόδοξοι** “empty glory” — used only here

Don't try to live the Christian life without Him. You have the Holy Spirit from the moment you believed.

Discuss and apply

Galatians 5:13–26 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. What would it look like to “wash someone's feet” today — literally or figuratively — in your own relationships?

2. Which fruit of the Spirit do you most need to grow in right now, and what's one step toward depending on the Spirit for it?

Apply

Serve Through Love, Not License
Do one lowly, unglamorous task for someone this week — unasked, and without mentioning it.

Let the Root Produce the Fruit
Name the fruit you most need, and instead of resolving to try harder, spend time asking the Spirit for it.

In one line: Liberty is lived by walking in step with the Spirit, who grows what the law could only demand.

Study 14 of 16 · Galatians 6:1–5

Brothers and Burdens

The Spirit-filled community that gently restores a brother overtaken in sin also expects each believer, without comparison or self-deception, to carry and one day give account for his own work before the Lord.

Two burdens, two Greek words

Galatians 6:2 and 6:5 · The key to the passage

“Bear one another's burdens” — v.2
βάρη barē · a crushing weight

- Too heavy for one person to lift
- Calls for the help of the body
- So fulfill the law of Christ

“Each one shall bear his own load” — v.5
φορτίον phortion · a soldier's own pack

- Carried by him alone
- Personal stewardship and service
- Accountability at the judgment seat of Christ

Help with what is unbearable — and carry what is yours. Both are true at once.

Restoring a brother

Galatians 6:1 · Outline I.A — The exhortation

The sinning believer	The spiritual believer	The goal	The manner
προλημφθῇ “overtaken in any trespass” — a slip, caught by surprise	**πνευματικοί** Walking in the Spirit (5:16–25) — not sinless	**καταρτίζετε** Restore — mend the net, set the bone	**πραΰτητος** In gentleness, considering yourself
6:1a	*6:1b*	*6:1c*	*6:1d*

Restoration, never condemnation — gentleness guards against harshness toward him and pride in us.

The law of Christ and the self-deceived

Galatians 6:2–3 · Outline I.B — The explanation

v.2a	“Bear one another's burdens”	**βάρη** too heavy to carry alone
v.2b	“and so fulfill the law of Christ”	**ἀναπληρώσατε** fill up to full measure
v.3a	“If anyone thinks himself to be something, when he is nothing”	the danger after helping
v.3b	“he deceives himself”	**φρεναπατᾷ** self-fancy · used only here

The Christian army is said to be the only army that shoots its wounded. Let's not shoot our wounded.

Examine your own work

Galatians 6:4–5 · Outline II — Bear your own burden

Examination	Exaltation	Explanation
δοκιμαζέτω Test your own work — your service, not your salvation	**καύχημα** Rejoicing in yourself alone, not by comparing with another	**φορτίον** “Each one shall bear his own load”
v.4a	*v.4b*	*v.5*

Assurance does not come from self-examination

- It rests on God's promise to the one who believes — the examination here is about stewardship and reward

Discuss and apply

Galatians 6:1–5 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. Think of a time someone gently restored you after a failure. What made it feel like restoration rather than condemnation?

2. Is there a burden in your life right now too heavy to carry alone? Who could you ask to help carry it?

Apply

Restore, Don't Gossip
If a brother or sister has been overtaken, go to them privately and gently before mentioning it to anyone else.

Carry What's Too Heavy, Alone What's Yours
Ask someone specific for help with a crushing burden — or stop comparing and take one step in your own course.

In one line: Help carry what is too heavy; faithfully carry what is yours.

Study 15 of 16 · Galatians 6:6–10

Sowing and Reaping

Because God is never mocked, every believer's use of time, money and resources — starting with support of those who teach — is seed that will yield either decay or lasting reward, so we keep sowing to the Spirit without growing weary.

Sowing and reaping in four parts

Galatians 6:6–10 · The commentary's outline

I **The Performance · v.6**

Share all good things with the one who teaches you

II **The Principles · vv.7–8**

God is not mocked: four laws of the harvest

III **The Pledge · v.9**

A harvest in due season — if we do not lose heart

IV **The Priority · v.10**

Do good to all — especially the household of faith

“Share in all good things with him who teaches”

Galatians 6:6 · Outline I — The performance

The command — v.6
κατηχούμενος · κοινωνείτω taught · share

- Those taught the word share with the one who teaches
- An ongoing responsibility

Why it seemed strange

1. **The law**
   The temple system was already funded
2. **The Judaizers**
   They discouraged support of grace teachers
3. **Paul's own example**
   He waived his right (1 Cor 9) — his choice, not a rule

None of the three changed the believers' responsibility.

Four laws of the harvest

Galatians 6:7–8 · Outline II — The principles

1 We reap if we sow

Put in before you take out — “unless a grain of wheat falls into the ground and dies” (John 12:24)

2 We reap what we sow

Sow to the flesh → corruption (φθοράν); sow to the Spirit → everlasting life

3 We reap more than we sow

One kernel planted yields a full ear and more

4 We reap later than we sow

The farmer plants, waits, and harvests in its time

“Do not be deceived, God is not mocked” — μυκτηρίζεται: to turn up one's nose at Him.

“Will of the Spirit reap everlasting life”

Galatians 6:8 · The posted study's Free Grace reading

	The gift of eternal life	Reaping everlasting life (v.8)
Received by	Faith alone in Christ alone	Sowing to the Spirit — faithful living
When	The moment a person believes	In due season — at the harvest
Can it be lost?	Never	It can be forfeited by sowing to the flesh
What it is	Life itself — a free gift	Reward: ruling with Christ (cf. 5:21; 2 Tim 2:12)

Paul is writing to believers who already have eternal life. The harvest in view is reward.

Don't grow weary — and start at home

Galatians 6:9–10 · Outline III–IV — The pledge and the priority

v.9a	“Let us not grow weary while doing good”	**ἐγκακῶμεν** lose courage
v.9b	“for in due season we shall reap”	**καιρῷ ἰδίῳ** God's right time
v.9c	“if we do not lose heart”	**ἐκλυόμενοι** a runner giving out
v.10	“Do good to all, especially to those who are of the household of faith”	**οἰκείους** first, not only

Keep doing what the Lord has led you to do — until He leads you to do something else.

Discuss and apply

Galatians 6:6–10 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. What is one thing in your life that is clearly “sowing to the flesh,” and what would sowing to the Spirit look like in that same area?

2. Where have you been tempted to grow weary in doing good because you haven't yet seen a harvest?

Apply

Sow Into Your Teachers
Take one concrete step this week — financial or otherwise — to support someone who faithfully teaches you the word.

Don't Lose Heart
Recommit to a work for one more defined season, and ask someone to check in with you on it.

In one line: God is not mocked: keep sowing to the Spirit, and in due season you will reap.

Study 16 of 16 · Galatians 6:11–18

Teaching the Truth

Because nothing but the cross of Christ produces the new creation, the grace gospel must be presented persuasively, precisely, plainly, positively and personally — without adding to it or subtracting from it.

Five ways to present the truth

Galatians 6:11–18 · The commentary's outline

Persuasively	Precisely	Plainly	Positively	Personally
Large letters, in his own hand	Exposing motives; boasting only in the cross	Walk by this rule — peace and mercy	The marks of the Lord Jesus	Grace with your spirit, brethren
v.11	*vv.12–15*	*v.16*	*v.17*	*v.18*

Say what needs to be said, the way it needs to be said — without adding to the gospel or subtracting from it.

Unseen motives and upper motives

Galatians 6:12–15 · Outline II — Present the truth precisely

Their unseen motives — vv.12–13

1. Approval of people
εὐπροσωπῆσαι a good showing in the flesh

2. Avoidance of persecution
διώκωνται for the cross of Christ

3. Appearance of perfection
they don't keep the law themselves

4. Attitude of pride
καυχήσωνται boasting in your flesh

Paul's upper motives — vv.14–15

1. The cross — v.14
“God forbid that I should boast except in the cross”
ἐσταύρωται Perf. — the world crucified to me, and I to the world

2. Christ — v.15
Neither circumcision nor uncircumcision avails anything
καινὴ κτίσις a new creation — new in kind

Large letters and lasting marks

Galatians 6:11, 17 · Outline I and IV — Persuasively and positively

Persuasively — v.11
πηλίκοις γράμμασιν with how large letters

- Paul took the pen from his secretary
- A visible, forceful final emphasis
- Truth presented with weight, not indifference

Positively — v.17
στίγματα brand-marks of ownership

- Not mystical “stigmata”
- Real scars from stoning and beatings
- Proof of his dedication — let no one trouble me

You think I'm not dedicated? These marks say otherwise — I belong to the Lord Jesus.

Peace and mercy — on whom?

Galatians 6:16 · Outline III — Present the truth plainly

v.16a	“As many as walk according to this rule” — grace, plus not one thing	**κανόνι** a measuring rod — “canon”
v.16b	“peace and mercy be upon them” — the curse of 1:8–9 replaced by peace	accepted on what Christ has done
v.16c	“and upon the Israel of God” — believing Jews among them	not the church renamed Israel

We are accepted by God never more, and never less, than the moment we first believed.

Grace first, grace last

Galatians 1:3 and 6:18 · Outline V — Present the truth personally

1:3	3:1	4:12 · 4:31	6:18
χάρις “Grace to you and peace”	“O foolish Galatians! Who has bewitched you?”	“Brethren” — again and again	**χάρις** “The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with your spirit”
the greeting	*the rebuke*	*the appeal*	*the benediction*

Paul's last word to the Galatians is his first word to them, said one more time: grace.

Discuss and apply

Galatians 6:11–18 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. What modern equivalents of the Judaizers' motives — approval, avoiding conflict, appearing put-together, pride in numbers — show up in ministry today?

2. What does it look like practically to boast in nothing except the cross of Christ?

Apply

Check Your Own Unseen Motives

Name one motive honestly before God this week and ask Him to replace it with a desire to boast only in the cross.

Live as the New Creation You Are

Write down one way your new-creation identity in Christ should change a decision you're facing.

In one line: Grace first and grace last: boast only in the cross, and teach the truth without adding or subtracting.

Conclusion · Galatians 1–6

Grace to the end

There is one gospel — by grace through faith, plus not one thing. The ground is level at the cross. Stand fast in the liberty by which Christ has made us free, and walk in the Spirit. “The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with your spirit.”